BRANDON HALL HOTEL & SPA

RECEPTION FIRE ALARM ACTIVATION PROCEDURE

1. Immediate response

1. Treat every fire alarm activation as genuine. Stop normal reception duties and follow the hotel's established fire evacuation arrangements.

2. If safe and trained to do so, check the fire alarm control panel and note the displayed location or zone. Do not delay evacuation to investigate.

3. Inform the duty manager and designated fire wardens in accordance with the hotel's emergency communication arrangements. Do not silence, reset or isolate the alarm unless specifically authorised.

2. Contacting emergency services and warning guests

1. Call 999 and request Fire and Rescue in accordance with the emergency plan. If there is evidence of fire, smoke or immediate danger, call 999 immediately. Do not assume an alarm monitoring service has called.

2. Give the hotel name, confirmed address, alarm zone or location, any known smoke or fire, people at risk and a callback number.

3. Follow the hotel's evacuation strategy. Direct guests calmly to the designated safe exits and assembly point. Do not direct guests to use ordinary lifts.

3. Reception records and evacuation

1. Take the current guest occupancy report, staff sign-in/out register and contractor/visitor records only if immediately accessible and safe. Never delay evacuation to retrieve paperwork.

2. Leave by a safe route. Do not remain at reception to answer calls or check rooms if evacuation is required.

3. Provide assistance within your training and assigned responsibilities. Follow the hotel's arrangements for guests needing help to evacuate. Never enter smoke-filled areas or attempt an unsafe rescue.

4. Assembly point and fire service handover

1. Report to the duty manager or evacuation coordinator. Provide occupancy records, alarm panel information and details of anyone known to need assistance.

2. Assist with accounting for staff and guests under the hotel procedure. Sign-in records help identify people potentially on site but do not prove whether anyone remains inside.

3. Immediately report missing or unaccounted-for persons and their last known locations to the fire service. Do not send anyone back inside to search.

5. Re-entry and reporting

1. Do not allow re-entry until authorised under the hotel's emergency arrangements and consistent with instructions from the fire service.

2. Record the activation, actions taken, any defects, affected guests and follow-up actions. Escalate safety issues promptly.

6. Night-shift requirements

1. The same emergency principles apply overnight. At handover, confirm the alarm panel status, known defects, staff register and location of emergency information.

2. The night team must know who is responsible for calling 999, warning guests, assisting evacuation and briefing the fire service when staffing is reduced.

Operational reference: Staff must follow the hotel fire risk assessment, site-specific evacuation plan and management instructions where these specify additional or different arrangements.